

# Health Insurance & Vaccination Guide

Mandatory health insurance costs by country, plus the vaccinations universities commonly require before you arrive.

## Health Insurance Requirements by Country

| Country   | Requirement                                      | Approx. Cost                       |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| USA       | University-mandated health plan                  | \$1,500 - \$3,000/year             |
| UK        | Immigration Health Surcharge (IHS)               | GBP 776/year, paid upfront in full |
| Canada    | Provincial or private health coverage            | CAD \$600 - \$900/year             |
| Australia | OSHC (Overseas Student Health Cover) - mandatory | AUD \$500 - \$700/year             |
| Germany   | Public or private insurance - mandatory          | ~EUR 110/month (~EUR 1,320/year)   |

### UK Immigration Health Surcharge (IHS)

The IHS is paid upfront during your visa application, covering your entire course duration - a 3-year course means paying roughly 3 years' worth at once (GBP 776/year at the current student rate). This is non-refundable even if your visa is later refused, so budget for it as a sunk cost you commit to at application time.

## Commonly Required Vaccinations

- ☐ MMR (Measles, Mumps, Rubella) - two doses required by most universities
- ☐ Hepatitis B - a 3-dose series, mandatory for healthcare students in the USA, Canada, and Australia
- ☐ Meningococcal (MenACWY) - required by many US universities, especially for dorm residents
- ☐ Varicella (Chickenpox) - proof of immunity or vaccination, common in the USA and Canada
- ☐ Tdap (Tetanus, Diphtheria, Pertussis) - one dose if you haven't had one in the last 10 years
- ☐ COVID-19 - some universities still require proof of vaccination or booster doses

### When to get vaccinated

Get vaccinated after admission, once your university sends its specific health form - requirements vary by institution. Some vaccines (like the Hepatitis B series) need a 6-month timeline to complete, so start early rather than scrambling close to departure.